ÖPIA

Österreichische Plattform für Interdisziplinäre Alternsfragen
Austrian Interdisciplinary Platform on Ageing

Austrian Interdisciplinary Study of the Oldest Old

Wave iii

2019 - 2022

Description of the dataset

STUDY DESIGN AND METHODOLOGY

In the following, the study design and the methodology of the Austrian Interdisciplinary Study of the Oldest Old (Österreichische Interdisziplinäre Hochaltrigenstudie (ÖIHS), Welle III, 2019 – 2022) will be presented. In this way, the data is described in more detail, in particular the design and structure of the questionnaire and finally the variable names, variable descriptions and the number of variables in the dataset etc.

The ÖIHS examines the health, living and care situation of very old people (80+) in Austria. The quantitative survey was carried out primarily through personal, questionnaire-based interviews (PAPI) in private households and nursing homes. Some of the interviews (approximately 20%) had to be conducted in the form of shortened telephone interviews due to the Corona crisis. In addition to a questionnaire-based survey and a geriatric assessment, the ÖIHS also includes focus studies integrating qualitative methods. The combination of a quantitative and qualitative research approach ("mixed methods design") represents a unique selling point of the ÖIHS. The ÖIHS uses standardized and internationally comparable survey instruments. The survey is carried out exclusively by appropriately trained interviewers. The collected data were then statistically evaluated using both univariate and multivariate analysis methods (cf. ibid., pp 17). Interviews were conducted with a total of 717 women and men aged between 80 and 90 in Vienna, Lower Austria, Styria and Salzburg.

Sampling

The study participants were selected primarily by drawing a random sample from the central register of residents ("Zentrales Melderegister", ZMR). By drawing from the population register, mainly people living in private households were recorded (in some cases also people in retirement homes and assisted living facilities). In order to be able to take people living in nursing homes into account for the study, as planned in the study design, an additional sample of around 60 people in nursing homes was created. The sample was created in friendly cooperation with various care facilities in the participating federal states.

Part of the sample is made up of people, who have already taken part in previous survey waves and were interviewed again for longitudinal analyses. In total, a gross sample of around 3,000 people was drawn up. Based on the number of interviews carried out (n=717), this results in a response rate of approx. 24%. These numbers make it clear, how difficult it is to reach the target group for scientific studies.

Description of the questionnaire as a survey method

The thematic priorities of the study are health, lifestyle and care. These are examined in the context of socio-economic status, age and gender. A total of 717 people were interviewed using an extensive questionnaire. The basic structure of the questionnaire consisted of a demographic survey (gender, age, citizenship, etc.) and a survey on the following subject areas: health situation (height, chronic diseases, death of persons close to you, etc.); social networks and resources (household size, religiosity, sexuality, etc.), and personal preferences (powers of attorney and directives, etc.).

Literature

ÖPIA (2022): Österreichische Interdisziplinäre Hochaltrigenstudie, Welle III 2019-2022. Die Herausforderungen des hohen Alters. Wien: ÖPIA. Online verfügbar: http://www.oepia.at/hochaltrigkeit/wp-content/uploads/2022/07/OEIHS_Welle3-Endbericht_FINAL.pdf [Date of access: 15 Februar 2023]